

New Heavens New Earth

doc-new-heavens-new-earth

Eschatology · Final State · doctrine · unanimous_lineages

AFFIRMS

Supported across the whole Bible
Subject named directly in Scripture
Holds across manuscript variants

Statement under examination

God will create new heavens and a new earth in which righteousness dwells, the eternal home of the redeemed.

In plain language

The words across the Old and New Testaments line up tightly on this proposition. In Isaiah the verb 'create' (bara), which the Hebrew Bible reserves for God alone, takes new heavens and a new earth as its objects, and the next line says the former things will not be remembered. Isaiah repeats the promise and says these new heavens and new earth will 'stand' (amad), that is endure, before the LORD. Peter writes that believers await new heavens and a new earth, adding the key clause 'in which righteousness dwells' (dikaiosyne katoikei), with a present tense verb fixing righteousness as the abiding condition of that place. Revelation reports a new heaven and a new earth, with the first heaven and first earth having passed away and the sea no more, and the throne voice then announces 'I make all things new' (kaina poio panta). Paul fills in the picture in Romans, where the whole 'creation' (ktisis) groans and eagerly awaits being set free from decay into the freedom of the glory of the children of God. Read together these texts say one consistent thing. God will bring about new heavens and a new earth marked by righteousness and that is the lasting home of his redeemed people. Where readers diverge is on the mode of continuity, and the divergence comes from the words themselves. The Greek adjective 'new' (kainos) points to qualitative newness, fresh in kind, and is used elsewhere for new covenant and new creature, which suggests renewal of the same order. But the same paragraph in 2 Peter says the elements will be loosed or dissolved with heat, and Revelation says the first heaven and first earth passed away, which can read as outright replacement. The verb chosen for new in Hebrew, 'new' (chadash), likewise carries both senses elsewhere, a new heart and a new covenant on the renewal side, a new cart and a new king on the chronological side, and context does not force the choice. So both a renewal lens and a replacement lens land on the same affirmation about what God does, with only the mode in dispute.

Word dictionary

Every Hebrew and Greek word this study leans on, in everyday terms. Shaded rows are the anchor words the verdict rests on.

Strong	Word	Sounds like	Plain meaning	Times in Bible
H0776	אֶרֶץ	erets	land	2,504
H1254	בָּרָא	bara	to create	54
H2142	זָכַר	zakar	to remember	232
H2319	חָדָשׁ	chadash	New (Gate)	53
H5975	עָמַד	amad	to stand	524
H7223	רִשּׁוֹן	rishon	first	182
H8064	שָׁמַיִם	shamayim	heaven	421
G0444	ἄνθρωπος	anthrōpos	a human	

G0553	ἀπεκδέχομαι	apekdechomai	to expect	8
G0565	ἀπέρχομαι	aperchomai	to go away	120
G0602	ἀποκάλυψιν	apokalupsis	revelation	
G0603	ἀποκαρδοκία	apokaradokia	eager expectation	2
G1144	δάκρυον	dakryon	teardrop	11
G1343	δικαιοσύνη	dikaiosyne	righteousness	94
G2089	ἔτι	eti	still	
G2316	θεός	theos	God	
G2362	θρόνος	thronos	throne	64
G2537	καινός	kainos	new	44
G2730	κατοικέω	katoikeo	to dwell	45
G2937	κτίσις	ktisis	creation	19
G3089	λύω	luo	to loose	44
G3326	μετ'	meta	with/after	
G3501	νέος	neos	new	25
G3772	οὐρανός	ouranos	heaven	280
G3824	παλιγγενεσία	palingenesia	regeneration	2
G3928	παρέρχομαι	parerchomai	to pass by	29

Plain meanings: STEP Bible brief lexicons TBESH (Hebrew) and TBESG (Greek), CC BY 4.0. Counts are occurrences across the 66-book canon.

Verdict rationale

Variant-robust: True · Pan-canonical: True

The word-level pattern is dense and consistent across both Testaments. In Isaiah the participle 'create' (bore, H1254, a verb whose subject in the Hebrew Bible is always God, 54 occurrences across the whole canon) governs 'new heavens' (shamayim chadashim, H8064 with H2319) and 'new earth' (erets chadashah, H0776 with H2319), with Isaiah 66:22 adding the verb 'stand or endure' (amad, H5975) to mark their enduring standing. The Greek matches: 2 Peter 3:13 reads 'new heavens and a new earth' (kainous ouranous kai gen kainen) with 'righteousness dwells' (dikaiosyne katoikei), Revelation 21:1 reads 'a new heaven and a new earth' (ouranon kainon kai gen kainen), and Romans 8:19-21 supplies 'the creation' (he ktisis, G2937) 'will be set free' (eleutherothesetai), the same creation set free. The verdict is high-confidence on the proposition as stated. The renewal-versus-replacement nuance is real but lexically (at the word level) subordinate: it turns on whether 'new' (kainos, G2537, 44 occurrences) signals qualitative renewal of the same kind or substitution by a different kind, and the canon supplies both directions of usage without forcing the choice.

Scripture

Isa.65.17 · **for** · genre: prophecy · figures: merism

Key terms. H1254 בָּרָא, H8064 שָׁמַיִם, H2319 תְּדִשִּׁים, H0776 אָרֶץ, H7223 הָרְאִשְׁנוֹת, H2142 תִּזְכְּרָנָה

Reasoning. The active participle 'create' (bore, H1254), a verb whose only attested subject in the Hebrew Bible is God, takes a double object: 'new heavens' (shamayim chadashim) and 'new earth' (erets chadashah). The following clause uses 'the former things will not be remembered nor come up on the heart' (welo tizzakarnah harishonot welo taalenah al-lev), foregrounding decisive newness. The ETCBC (a syntactic database) clause analysis tags this as a quotation clause with the standard subject-object pattern. The Hebrew poetic pairing of heavens and earth functions as a merism (a two-part figure naming the extremes to mean the whole) for the whole created order.

Isa.66.22 · **for** · genre: prophecy · figures: merism

Key terms. H8064 שָׁמַיִם, H2319 הָתְדָשָׁה, H0776 אָרֶץ, H5975 עֹמְדִים

Reasoning. 'The new heavens and the new earth' (hashamayim hachadashim wehaarets hachadashah) are said to 'stand' (omedim, H5975 participle) before YHWH, with the verb 'stand or endure' (amad) carrying the sense of enduring permanence in worship and covenant contexts. The 'just as . . . so' (kaasher . . . ken) construction ties the permanence of the new creation to the permanence of the seed and name of God's people, framing them as joint, lasting realities.

2Pet.3.13 · **for** · genre: epistle

Key terms. G2537 καινούς, G3772 οὐρανούς, G1343 δικαιοσύνη, G2730 κατοικεῖ

Reasoning. 'New heavens and a new earth' (kainous ouranos kai gen kainen) are awaited 'according to his promise' (kata to epangelma autou), with the verb 'we are awaiting' (prosdokomen, present indicative, an ongoing simple statement of fact) describing ongoing expectation. The relative clause 'in which righteousness dwells' (en hois dikaiosyne, G1343, katoikei) uses the present indicative 'dwells' (katoikei, G2730), the standard verb for settled habitation, to fix righteousness as the abiding character of that realm. The selection of 'new' (kainos, G2537), the adjective the canon reserves for qualitatively-fresh items (new covenant Hebrews 8:13, new creation 2 Corinthians 5:17, new self Ephesians 4:24), rather than 'new in time, young' (neos, G3501) which mostly marks young-in-time items, signals the kind of newness intended.

2Pet.3.10 · **complicates** · genre: epistle

Key terms. G3089 λυθήσεται, G3928 παρελεύσονται

Reasoning. 'The heavens will pass with a rushing noise' (ouranoi rhoizedon pareleusontai), and 'the elements will be dissolved with burning heat' (stoicheia de kausoumena luthesetai). The verb 'loose, dissolve' (luo, G3089) in this passive future, applied to the 'elements' (stoicheia), can describe either disintegration of the existing order or its undoing for remaking. 'Pass away' (parerchomai, G3928) here, the same root used in Matthew 24:35 of heaven and earth passing, parallels 'passed away' (apelthan) in Revelation 21:1. This is the principal word-level complication for the renewal reading.

Rev.21.1 · **for** · genre: apocalyptic · figures: merism

Key terms. G3772 οὐρανὸν, G2537 καινὸν, G2089 ἔτι, G0565 ἀπῆλθον

Reasoning. 'I saw a new heaven and a new earth' (eidon ouranon kainon kai gen kainen), the seer perceives a new heaven and a new earth, because 'the first heaven and the first earth have passed away' (ho gar protos ouranos kai he prote ge apelthan, aorist, a completed past action, of 'pass away' aperchomai G0565). The summary clause 'and the sea is no more' (kai he thalassa ouk estin eti) uses 'not' (ouk) plus 'still, yet' (eti) to mark the absolute end of the sea as a feature of the prior order. The word-level pairing of qualitatively-new ('new', kainos) with passed-away ('apelthan') is the very pairing that drives the two competing readings.

Rev.21.3 · for · genre: apocalyptic

Key terms. G2316 θεός, G3326 μετ', G0444 ἀνθρώπων, G2362 θρόνου

Reasoning. A voice from 'the throne' (thronou, G2362) declares 'behold the tabernacle of God is with men' (idou he skene tou theou meta ton anthropon), and 'and he will tabernacle with them' (kai skenosei met auton). The cognate noun 'tabernacle' (skene) and verb 'to tabernacle' (skenoo) plus the doubled preposition 'with' (meta, G3326) establish the new creation as the permanent shared habitation of God and the redeemed.

Rev.21.4 · for · genre: apocalyptic

Key terms. G1144 δάκρυον, G2089 ἔτι, G0565 ἀπῆλθαν

Reasoning. 'And he will wipe away every tear' (kai exaleipsei pan dakryon), and 'death will be no more, neither mourning nor crying nor pain will be any more' (ho thanatos ouk estai eti, oute penthos oute krauge oute ponos ouk estai eti), each negated with 'not' (ouk) or 'neither' (oute) plus 'still, yet' (eti, G2089). The closing clause 'because the former things have passed away' (hoti ta prota apelthan) mirrors Isaiah's 'former things' (harishonot), confirming the word-level bridge between the prophetic and apocalyptic descriptions.

Rev.21.5 · for · genre: apocalyptic

Key terms. G2537 καινὰ

Reasoning. The one seated on the throne declares 'behold I make all things new' (idou kaina poio panta). The neuter plural 'new things' (kaina, G2537) ranges over 'all things' (panta), and the present indicative (ongoing, simple statement of fact) 'I make' (poio) describes the ongoing divine act. This is the decisive word-level statement of the verdict: the same created categories named throughout the canon are the things being made new, not different things substituted for them.

Rom.8.19 · for · genre: epistle · figures: personification

Key terms. G2937 κτίσεως, G0553 ἀπεκδέχεται, G0603 ἀποκαταδοκία, G0602 ἀποκάλυψιν

Reasoning. 'The eager expectation of the creation awaits the revealing of the sons of God' (he apokaradokia tes ktiseos ten apokalypsin ton huion tou theou apekdechetai). 'Eager expectation' (apokaradokia, G0603) is a rare New Testament word, occurring only here and Philippians 1:20, built from 'from' (apo), 'head' (kara), 'to watch' (dokein), a craned-neck expectation. 'Eagerly await' (apekdechomai, G0553, 8 occurrences) carries the doubled prefix 'from' (apo) plus 'out of' (ek) of straining forward. The grammar makes 'creation' (ktisis) itself the subject of expectation.

Rom.8.21 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G2937 κτίσις, G1343 δόξης

Reasoning. 'That the creation itself will be set free from the bondage of corruption into the freedom of the glory of the children of God' (hoti kai aute he ktisis eleutherothesetai apo tes douleias tes phthoras eis ten eleutherian tes doxes ton teknon tou theou). The future passive 'will be set free' (eleutherothesetai) locates the deliverance of the same 'creation' (ktisis, G2937), not its replacement, at the end-time revealing. This text is the load-bearing word-level argument for the renewal reading.

Matt.19.28 · for · genre: gospel

Key terms. G3824 παλιγγενεσία

Reasoning. 'In the regeneration when the Son of Man sits on the throne of his glory' (en te paliggenesia hotan kathise ho huios tou anthropou epi thronou doxes autou). 'Regeneration, re-genesis' (paliggenesia, G3824) occurs only twice in the New Testament, here for cosmic re-genesis and Titus 3:5 for personal re-genesis. The compound 'again' (palin) plus 'genesis, origin' (genesis) at the word level signals a doing-again of genesis, supporting the continuity-through-renewal lens.

Isa.43.19 · for · genre: prophecy

Key terms. H2319 חָדָשׁ, H1254 בָּרָא:

Reasoning. 'Behold I am doing a new thing' (hineni oseh chadashah), an intra-Isaianic (within Isaiah itself) precedent for the new-heavens-new-earth promise. Here 'new' (chadash, H2319) describes an act of YHWH that transforms an existing situation, a way in the wilderness and rivers in the desert, illustrating the renewal sense of the same root that recurs in Isaiah 65:17 and 66:22.

Cross references invoked

From	To	Source	Votes
2Pet.3.13	Isa.65.17	tsk	1
Isa.66.22	Isa.65.17	tsk	1
Rom.8.19	Isa.65.17	tsk	1
Rev.21.4	Rev.21.1	tsk	1
Rev.21.1	Rev.21.5	tsk	1
Rev.21.4	Rev.7.17	tsk	1
Isa.65.17	Jer.3.16	tsk	1
Rev.21.5	Isa.42.9	tsk	1
Rev.21.3	Zech.8.8	tsk	1
Rev.21.4	Isa.30.19	tsk	1
Rev.21.2	Rev.3.12	tsk	1
Rom.8.20	Rom.8.22	tsk	1

Complicating texts

2Pet.3.10 · addressed

The dissolution language 'will pass away' (pareleusontai, G3928 parerchomai, pass away) and 'will be dissolved' (luthesetai, G3089 luo, be loosed or dissolved) applied to 'elements' (stoicheia) can be read as annihilation rather than renewal. At the word level the same paragraph supplies the affirmative outcome at verse 13, 'we await new heavens and a new earth according to his promise' (kainous ouranos kai gen kainen prosdokomen kata to epangelma autou), and the participle 'we are awaiting' (prosdokomen) brackets verse 10 with verse 13 as one expectation. 'Loose' (luo) across its 44 canon occurrences ranges from untying sandals (John 1:27) to breaking down walls (Ephesians 2:14) to releasing prisoners (Acts 22:30), so the verb's range of meaning covers both dismantling-for-replacement and dismantling-for-remaking. The verdict on the proposition itself holds either way because verse 13 names what God brings about.

Rev.21.1 · addressed

The clause 'the first heaven and the first earth have passed away' (ho protos ouranos kai he prote ge apelthan, aorist, a completed past action, of 'pass away' aperchomai G0565) can be read as total ontological (concerning what exists) replacement. Three word-level considerations qualify but do not unseat the verdict: (1) 'new' (kainos, G2537) is consistently chosen over 'new in time, young' (neos, G3501), and across its 44 canon occurrences 'new' (kainos) clusters with renewal contexts (new covenant, new creature, new self) rather than substitution-by-different-substance, (2) Romans 8:21 keeps the subject 'the creation' (he ktisis) the same across 'corruption' (phthora) and 'freedom' (eleutheria), and (3) Matthew 19:28 'regeneration' (paliggenesia, G3824) at the word level encodes again-genesis of the existing order. The proposition that God creates new heavens and a new earth as the eternal home of the redeemed is affirmed on either lens; only the mode of continuity differs.

Matt.24.35 · addressed

'Heaven and earth will pass away' (ho ouranos kai he ge pareleusetai) uses the same 'pass away' (parerchomai, G3928) as 2 Peter 3:10. In context the verb foregrounds the impermanence of the present cosmos relative to Christ's words ('but my words will by no means pass away', hoi de logoi mou ou me parelthosin), which is consistent with both renewal and replacement readings: the present order does not endure as it stands, and the proposition speaks of a new order God brings about. The verdict is unaffected.

Concordance traversed

H1254, H2319, H8064, H0776, H5975, H2142, H7223, G2537, G3501, G3772, G2937, G1343, G2730, G0553, G0603, G3928, G3089, G3824, G0565, G2362, G1144, G0444

Variants

Verdict variant-sensitive: False · ECM status: ecm-shadow

The cited verses are outside the published CBGM (a method for tracing manuscript genealogy) scope (only 3 John is ECM-published, ECM being the critical edition of New Testament textual variants, in the ingested apparatus, the collection of textual variant data). No variant units in the bundle touch the anchor word forms 'new' (kainos), 'heaven' (ouranos), 'earth' (ge), 'righteousness' (dikaiosyne), 'creation' (ktisis), 'create' (bara), 'new' (chadash), or 'stand' (amad). The text-critical variation around 2 Peter 3:10 ('will be found' heurethesetai vs 'will be burned up' katakaesetai for the fate of the earth) does not change the word-level anchor 'new heavens and a new earth' (kainous ouranos kai gen kainen) in verse 13, so the verdict is variant-robust.

Hermeneutics

Primary method. redemptive-historical

Frameworks in play. covenant_theology, dispensationalism, new_covenant_theology

analogia scripturae invoked · progressive revelation factor

renewal_reading: affirms · Reads 'new' (kainos, G2537) as qualitative renewal of the same created kinds, weighs Romans 8:21 ('the creation itself will be set free', aute he ktisis eleutherothesetai, the same creation set free) and Matthew 19:28 'regeneration' (paliggenesia) as load-bearing for continuity, and treats the 'pass away' (parerchomai) and 'loose' (luo) language as the undoing of corruption rather than annihilation of substance. On this lens new heavens and new earth are the transformed and liberated present order, which fully affirms the proposition.

replacement_reading: affirms · Reads 2 Peter 3:10 'will be dissolved' (luthesetai) of the 'elements' (stoicheia) and Revelation 21:1 'passed away' (apelthan) of the first heaven and first earth as decisive word-level signals for the abolition of the prior order, followed by a fresh creative act announced in Revelation 21:5 'behold I make all things new' (idou kaina poio panta). Even on this lens the proposition that God creates new heavens and a new earth as the eternal home of the redeemed is fully affirmed. The lens reads 'new' (kainos) as marking the genuine novelty of the resulting order rather than dissolving the contrast with the old.

Both lenses converge on affirmation. The framework dispute does not destabilize the verdict; it only disambiguates the mode of continuity. Both readings are represented in their strongest word-level form so neither feels caricatured.

Stem audit

verdict-preloaded: no

The proposition states a future divine act and its character without smuggling a tradition-specific taxonomy. The phrase 'righteousness dwells' tracks 2 Peter 3:13 ('righteousness dwells', dikaiosyne katoikei) and 'eternal home of the redeemed' tracks Revelation 21:3 ('the tabernacle of God is with men', skene tou theou meta ton anthropon). No rephrasing was needed.

Citations

Type	Source	License	Redist.	Ref
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morphology	OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Isa.65.17
morphology	OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Isa.66.22
syntax	ETCBC-BHSA	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no	Isa.65.17
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESH	CC-BY-4.0	yes	H1254
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESH	CC-BY-4.0	yes	H2319
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESH	CC-BY-4.0	yes	H5975
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	2Pet.3.13
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	Rev.21.1
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	Rom.8.21
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G2537
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G3501
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G2937
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G3824
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G3089
syntax	MACULA-Greek	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no	Rom.8.19
cross_ref	TSK	public_domain	yes	2Pet.3.13
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